ZOHO INTERVIEW EXPERIENCE

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Role: Software Developer

Interview Process

There were **6 rounds**.

1. Java + Aptitude Test
2. Coding Round
3. Console-Based Application Design
4. Technical Interview 1
5. Technical Interview 2
6. HR Interview

Round 1 – Java + Aptitude (75 Minutes)

The first round consisted of **20 questions**.

- **10 Java Output Prediction Questions**
- **10 Aptitude Questions**

There were **no compilation errors** in the Java programs. We were instructed to ignore missing imports and syntax-related omissions and predict the output.

Examples:

- Valid Palindrome II - 680
- Smaller Numbers Than Current - 1365
- Valid Mountain Array - 941
- Search Insert Position - 35

- Can Place Flowers - 605
- Counting Bits - 338
- Two Sum using Binary Search - 167
- Build Array from Permutation - 1920
- String character comparison – Not leetcode
- Increasing Triplet Subsequence - 334

The Java questions mainly tested:

- Arrays
- Strings
- Binary Search
- Greedy
- Two Pointer
- Bit Manipulation
- Prefix Sum
- Basic Algorithm Analysis

Aptitude Topics

Questions were from:

- Probability (Dice)
- Ages
- Speed, Distance & Time
- Permutations & Combinations
- Pipes & Cisterns
- Ratio & Proportion
- Profit & Loss
- Percentage
- Simple Algebra

Round 2 – Coding Round

Important Rule

Java built-in Map/HashMap/TreeMap or similar collections were NOT allowed for all coding questions.

The coding round was divided into two sections.

Section A (40 Minutes) (Only after completing this we can move to next section)

Question 1

Generate the following pattern.

Condition

- Do NOT create an array.

Input

5

Output

```
          1
        6 2
      10 7 3
    13 11 8 4
 15 14 12 9 5
```

The interviewer mainly checked mathematical thinking instead of brute-force storage.

Question 2

LeetCode – 121 **Best Time to Buy and Sell Stock**

Additional condition: if you solved using two loops

- Solve using **only one loop** will be the next task.

Expected Time Complexity:

O(n)

Section B (Approximately 2 Hours)

Question 3

Given a string and screen length, make the string exactly fit the screen width by distributing '*' between words.

Input

Today is a good day

Screen Length = 28

Output

Today****is***a***good***day

Rules:

- Screen length is always greater than string length.
- Distribute '*' as equally as possible.
- If stars cannot be equally divided, assign the extra stars starting from the leftmost gaps.

This is similar to the text justification problem.

Question 4

Convert a number into English words.

Range

1 <= N <= 99999

Example

Input:

30

Output:

Thirty

Question 5

Rearrange an array as:

Maximum

Minimum

Second Maximum

Second Minimum …

Conditions

- Do NOT sort the array.
- Do NOT create a new array.

Example

Input

[2,4,6,7,3]

Output

[7,2,6,3,4]

This tested in-place manipulation and algorithm design.

Round 3 – Console-Based Application Design

We were given **two A4 sheets** and asked to design a complete console application.

Problem Statement:

Design a **Company Stock Management System**.

The company:

- Purchases products from vendors
- Sells products to customers

Need to generate:

- Purchase Bill
- Sales Bill

Purchase Bill should maintain

- Paid Status
- Received Status

Sales Bill should maintain

- Paid Status
- Delivered Status

Functional Requirements

The system should support:

- Current stock of a product
- Quantity yet to be received
- Quantity yet to be delivered
- Stock value of a product
- Overall company stock value
- Number of products sold during a given date range

Additional Questions

They further extended the design by asking:

- Profit earned from a particular product
- Profit earned from a particular customer
- Overall profit during a specified date range

What They Evaluated

This round was **not about coding**.

Instead, they evaluated:

- Requirement gathering
- Object-Oriented Design
- Class relationships
- Database/entity design
- Flow of execution
- Problem understanding

For every requirement, they expected us to explain:

- Which class handles it?
- Which object is responsible?
- What is the flow?
- Which data should be updated?
- Which tables/classes are involved?

Round 4 – Technical Interview 1

This interview focused mainly on projects and internships.

The interviewer asked me to explain:

- End-to-end project flow
- Problem statement
- Architecture
- Technologies used
- How each module works
- Challenges faced

After the project discussion, I was asked around **6–7 aptitude questions**.

Topics included:

- Work and Time
- Pipes & Cisterns
- Average of consecutive numbers
- Largest number from average
- Pen offer problem

Example:

One pen costs ₹12. For every 5 pens purchased, 1 pen is free.

If I have ₹365, how many pens can I get?

They also asked percentage-based questions like:

- 25% increase followed by 20% decrease
- Net percentage change

Round 5 – Technical Interview 2

This interview focused more on technical fundamentals.

Subjects discussed:

- Java
- SQL
- Other technologies mentioned in the resume

The interviewer went deeper into Java concepts.

I was also asked to write an SQL query involving:

- JOIN
- GROUP BY
- ORDER BY

During the interview, the interviewer suddenly asked a few quick aptitude calculations such as:

- 5% of 37 and 8% of 69
- 162 + 269

These were intended to test quick mental calculations.

Round 6 – HR Interview

The HR discussion was short and conversational.

Questions included:

- Tell me about yourself.
- Where are you from?
- Tell me about your family.
- Why Zoho?
- If you don't get selected this time, what will you do?

The HR mainly observed communication skills, confidence, attitude, and overall personality.